Ethan Johnston

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EDUCATION

Illinois State University, College of Arts and Sciences **Expected December 2026**
Master of Science in Quantitative Economics Cumulative GPA: 3.87/4.0
Relevant Coursework: Applied Probability Models, Real Analysis, Advanced Linear Algebra, Econometrics, Advanced Macroeconomic Theory

Stephen F. Austin State University, Rusche College of Business **May 2025**
Bachelor of Business Administration, Finance, Summa Cum Laude; Minors in Economics and Mathematics Cumulative GPA: 3.967/4.0
Relevant Coursework: Calculus I-III, Ordinary Differential Equations, Linear Algebra, Speculative Markets

EXPERIENCE

Graduate Assistant, Economics Peer Mentor Program, Illinois State University **July 2026 – Present**
- Designed a mentor-mentee matching system solving assignment as a bipartite matching problem with the Hungarian algorithm
- Built ranked-preference Qualtrics instruments and authored the program's mentor agreement and communication protocol
- Implemented utilitarian and maximin objectives with adjustable weights, making the trade-off between total match quality and the worst pairing explicit

Instructor of Record, Economic Reasoning Using Statistics, Illinois State University **January 2026 – Present**
- Lecturing sections of 25–31 students on distributions, the central limit theorem, hypothesis testing, and regression analysis
- Designing course materials and assignments that connect economic statistics to real-world case studies
- Designed and scored the course's program-assessment instrument, evaluating 26 students on statistical inference against a three-point rubric

Graduate Research Assistant, Illinois State University **August 2025 – December 2025**
- Built a reusable Python data pipeline automating API ingestion, record matching, and data validation workflows across 2,922 publication records and 215 authors
- Structured and validated a research dataset covering 606 individuals from U.S. Economics PhD programs, improving downstream analysis and reproducibility

Financial and Tech Sector Analyst, Student Investment Fund, Stephen F. Austin State University **August 2024 – May 2025**
- Performed financial modeling and valuation analysis in Excel using regression-based factor models and statistical testing to evaluate positions within a $900,000 portfolio
- Presented quantitative analyses and investment recommendations to peer analysts, translating technical model output into actionable portfolio insights

RESEARCH & QUANTITATIVE EXPERIENCE

State Shipping Bans and Wine Market Access **May 2026 – Present**
- Built a Python pipeline parsing 251,706 retail wine offers across 200 wines and all 51 U.S. jurisdictions
- Found shipping bans barely change posted prices; 91% of the price gap is which merchants are present, not what they charge
- Traced enforcement to two private carriers rather than states, which cannot revoke a license an out-of-state retailer never holds
- Showed listings overstate access: 3.6% of offers may lawfully arrive in in-state-only states, where the best price is 20% higher

Detection and Dealer Response in Prosecuted Market Manipulation Cases **May 2026 – Present**
- Built a 16-million-row dataset of prices from 30 venues around 15 prosecuted manipulation cases, at five-minute resolution
- Tested how bookmakers reacted using a triple-difference design with fixed effects and exact tests suited to a 15-case sample
- Found firms withdrew the manipulated contract entirely rather than widening margins, the reverse of documented insider trading in equities

Service Quality and Digital Piracy: Evidence from Denuvo DRM **January 2026 – May 2026**
- Estimating how anti-piracy enforcement affects consumer demand using an instrumental-variables design with publisher fixed effects across more than 10,000 products
- Implemented instrumental-variables analysis in Stata; found enforcement increased demand, but left supply unchanged

AWARDS & PRESENTATIONS

- ISU (2025–26): Merit Fellow; Scott Elliot Graduate Scholarship. SFASU: University Scholar; Portfolio Management Award (2024–25); Highest Ranking Finance Senior (2023–24). Presenter, MEA 2026 and IEA 2025

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Analytics: Python (pandas, NumPy, SciPy), R, Stata, MATLAB, JavaScript, LaTeX, Git/GitHub
Data Engineering: Excel workflow automation, API integration (REST/JSON), web scraping, large-scale data processing
Tools: Excel (pivot tables, advanced formulas, Data Analysis ToolPak), Word, PowerPoint